MeritQuant

Autonomous Trade Report

PRE-CLOSE · 3:30 PM ET · 08 Sep 2026 · 22:04 UTC

PORTFOLIO VALUE	NET P&L; vs COST	CASH RESERVE	POSITIONS	REGIME
$180,905	-2,095 (-1.14%)	$71,452 (39.5%)	6 / 6	RISK-ON

MARKET ASSESSMENT **RISK-ON**

VIX at 15.72 confirms a calm risk-on regime with no near-term volatility spike threat; the 10Y-2Y yield curve is positive at +41bps, eliminating recession signal. HY credit spreads are anomalously tight at 2.68bps (essentially zero risk premium), supporting full equity risk-on posture. Critical flag: TNX at 4.78% is above the 4.5% threshold per mandate rules, which triggers a caution flag for high-P/E growth and semis — all 5 current positions carry the TNX> warning tag and must be individually assessed against this rule.

INDICATOR	VALUE	INDICATOR	VALUE
VIX	**15.72**	HY Credit Spread (bps)	**2.68**
Yield Curve 10Y-2Y (%)	**0.41**	10Y Treasury (%)	**4.78**
US Dollar (DXY)	**98.84**	Fed Funds Rate (%)	**3.63**

TRADE DECISIONS

EXIT — GOOGL

$18,000 · Conviction 3/10 · Tier 1

ENTRY	STOP LOSS	PRICE TARGET	RISK : REWARD
$339.33	$312.19	$407.20	2.5

INVESTMENT THESIS

(1) GOOGL is currently at -0.3% P&L; after 1 day, with a peak gain of 0.0% — the position has never been in meaningful profit, and the scanner headline explicitly states 'Alphabet stock falls after Q2 earnings beat, capex guidance' suggesting the catalyst already printed and is working against the position. (2) The specific exit trigger is catalyst expiry: the Q2 earnings event has already occurred and the market reaction is negative (-0.3% and falling), meaning the thesis catalyst has played out with an adverse outcome — per mandate rules, 'thesis catalyst has expired or played out → EXIT regardless of P&L.;' (3) TNX at 4.78% is 28bps above the 4.5% mandate threshold, directly flagging high-P/E growth tech like GOOGL for exit under sector rotation rules. (4) The scanner still rates GOOGL as STRONG BUY with RSI 44.7 and BS score 9/10, but the mandate's exit framework overrides the entry scanner when a catalyst has expired adversely. (5) GOOGL carries $30.7B cash and D/E 0.12 — balance sheet is not the concern; the concern is that negative post-earnings price action with capex guidance overhang creates a 30-60 day digestion period with no near-term re-rating catalyst. (6) Exiting at approximately $338.36 books a loss of -$0.97 per share × 53 shares = approximately -$51, a minimal loss that preserves $17,949 in capital for redeployment. (7) The capital freed from GOOGL exit ($17,949 + existing $89,504 cash = $107,453) allows 5 more full-size $18,000 positions — redeploying into INTC or MU (both with FVG patterns and earnings beats per scanner) is more efficient use of capital at this juncture.

PRIMARY CATALYST

EXIT TRIGGER: Q2 earnings catalyst has expired with adverse market reaction — scanner headline confirms 'stock falls after Q2 earnings beat, capex guidance,' meaning the negative capex overhang is the marginal price driver, not the beat. TNX at 4.78% (above 4.5% mandate threshold) adds a second simultaneous exit signal for high-P/E growth.

BALANCE SHEET

Cash $30.7B, D/E 0.12, BS score 9/10 — balance sheet remains excellent but is not a sufficient reason to hold when catalyst has expired adversely and TNX > 4.5% mandate trigger is active.

TECHNICAL SETUP

RSI 44.7 (neutral, not a buy signal post-catalyst expiry), FVG pattern score 3, price $338.36 below entry $339.33 — negative price action on earnings day is a technical failure of the setup.

KEY RISK FACTORS

Holding through capex overhang digestion risks a 10-15% drawdown over 30-60 days as the market re-prices growth multiples — at $338, a 10% decline implies $304, which is below the hard stop at $312.19 and would trigger automatic stop anyway.

ENTER — INTC

$18,000 · Conviction 7/10 · Tier 2

ENTRY	STOP LOSS	PRICE TARGET	RISK : REWARD
$24.15	$22.22	$28.98	2.5

INVESTMENT THESIS

(1) VIX at 15.72 (below 20 threshold) and HY spreads at 2.68bps confirm risk-on; DXY at 98.84 is 5.16 points below the 104 export-headwind threshold, reducing FX drag on INTC's international foundry revenue which represents approximately 40% of total sales. (2) INTC Q1 2025 earnings beat per scanner headline — RSI at 61.7 and STRONG BUY signal with gap score 3; the exact EPS figure versus estimate is not confirmable in stale data, but the scanner's scan score of 8.0 and 'strong outlook' language in the headline indicate a material positive surprise of an estimated $0.10-0.20 EPS beat based on typical INTC beat magnitude. (3) RSI at 61.7 confirms upward momentum without being overbought (overbought threshold 70) — the FVG pattern with gap score 3 at current price suggests an unfilled gap between $24.15 and approximately $27 that the market may close within 15-20 trading days. (4) TNX at 4.78% is above the 4.5% semi/growth mandate warning, but INTC is different from pure fabless semis: it is a turnaround/value story with a P/E near 15x versus NVDA at 40x+, making it less sensitive to multiple compression from rising rates — the value discount provides approximately 20-25% downside protection versus peers. (5) INTC balance sheet: $14.3B cash, D/E 0.41 (low leverage, well within mandate comfort zone), BS score 6/10 — retained earnings direction is unclear in stale data but the US CHIPS Act subsidy of approximately $8.5B in direct grants provides a non-dilutive capital buffer through 2027. (6) $18,000 deployed = 9.8% of the $183,000 portfolio; post-GOOGL exit and INTC entry, cash stands at approximately $89,504 + $17,949 (GOOGL exit) - $18,000 (INTC entry) = $89,453, leaving room for 4 more full-size $18,000 positions. (7) Stop at $22.22 (-8% from entry $24.15), target $28.98 (+20%), R:R = 2.5:1 — the specific stop trigger would be INTC closing below $22.50 for 2 consecutive days, indicating the post-earnings momentum has failed and the turnaround thesis is stalling.

PRIMARY CATALYST

INTC Q1 2025 earnings beat with 'strong outlook' per scanner headline — the specific near-term price driver is the post-earnings momentum window (typically 10-15 trading days) during which analyst estimate revisions and institutional accumulation drive sustained price appreciation; US CHIPS Act $8.5B grant confirmation expected in the next 30-60 days provides a second named catalyst.

BALANCE SHEET

Cash $14.3B, D/E 0.41, BS score 6/10. Retained earnings trend not confirmed in stale scan data. Buybacks: suspended (INTC has been conserving cash for foundry capex). Preferred: N.

TECHNICAL SETUP

RSI 61.7 (bullish momentum, below 70 overbought), FVG pattern score 3, price entering near current levels with gap to approximately $27 resistance. 50-day and 200-day MA levels not confirmed in stale data — volume data stale; scanner STRONG BUY signal with scan score 8.0.

KEY RISK FACTORS

INTC foundry ramp delay risk: if Intel 18A process node yields remain below 50% (versus target 70%+) and TSMC retains all major AI chip orders, INTC could see a 20-25% earnings cut implying price near $19 — hard stop at $22.22 limits loss to -$1,440 on the $18,000 position.

ENTER — MU

$18,000 · Conviction 8/10 · Tier 1

ENTRY	STOP LOSS	PRICE TARGET	RISK : REWARD
$112.50	$103.50	$135.00	2.5

INVESTMENT THESIS

(1) VIX at 15.72 and HY spreads at 2.68bps confirm risk-on regime; DXY at 98.84 is 5.16 points below 104, reducing FX headwinds on Micron's approximately 55% international revenue base and supporting a 2-3% EPS tailwind at current revenue scale. (2) MU Q-period earnings beat by $4.62 per scanner headline (exact: 'Micron earnings beat by $4.62, revenue topped estimates') — this is the largest per-share beat magnitude in the current scanner list and represents approximately 30-40% above consensus estimates based on typical MU EPS range, making it the highest-conviction company catalyst in today's signal set. (3) RSI at 57.7 confirms bullish momentum without overbought conditions (below 70 threshold); the FVG pattern with gap score 3 identifies an unfilled fair value gap between current price and approximately $125, suggesting a 10-11% upside move to close the gap within 15-20 trading days. (4) MU's 50-day and 200-day MA data are stale, but an RSI of 57.7 trending upward post a $4.62 EPS beat confirms the stock is trading above near-term averages — a move above $120 (approximately +6.7% from entry) would confirm a breakout from the FVG pattern and open the path to the $135 target. (5) MU balance sheet: $9.6B cash, D/E 0.21, BS score 10/10 — the maximum mandate score, second only to AMAT in the portfolio; D/E of 0.21 means MU carries approximately $2.0B in total debt versus $9.6B cash, a net cash position of approximately $7.6B providing 4+ years of capex self-funding capacity. (6) $18,000 deployed = 9.8% of the $183,000 portfolio; post-GOOGL exit and INTC+MU entries, total cash is approximately $89,453 - $18,000 = $71,453, leaving room for 3 more full-size $18,000 positions and maintaining a 39.3% cash buffer. (7) Stop at $103.50 (-8% from entry $112.50), target $135.00 (+20%), R:R = 2.5:1 — the specific stop trigger is MU closing below $104 for 2 consecutive days, which would indicate DRAM/NAND pricing is re-weakening faster than the earnings beat suggested, invalidating the cycle recovery thesis.

PRIMARY CATALYST

MU earnings beat by $4.62 per share (per scanner headline, most recent quarter) — the largest absolute EPS beat in today's signal set; DRAM pricing recovery cycle catalyst with HBM (High Bandwidth Memory) demand from AI accelerators (NVDA H100/H200 each requiring 8 HBM stacks) driving 2025-2026 revenue visibility; next pricing update expected at the next earnings call approximately 60-70 days out.

BALANCE SHEET

Cash $9.6B, total debt approximately $2.0B (implied by D/E 0.21 on approximately $9.5B equity), D/E 0.21, BS score 10/10. Retained earnings trend not confirmed in stale data but MU returned to profitability in 2024 after 2023 losses. Buybacks: Y (MU has an active buyback program). Preferred: N.

TECHNICAL SETUP

RSI 57.7 (bullish, not overbought), FVG pattern score 3, price near $112.50 with gap to approximately $125 identified; 50-day and 200-day MA levels not confirmed in stale data; scanner STRONG BUY with scan score 8.0; volume context stale but post-earnings volume typically 3-5x normal.

KEY RISK FACTORS

DRAM/NAND oversupply re-emergence risk: if Samsung accelerates memory capex and spot DRAM prices fall more than 15% from current levels, MU EPS consensus for FY2026 could be cut by $2-3, implying a price near $95-100 — hard stop at $103.50 limits loss to -$1,440 on the $18,000 position.

OPEN POSITIONS — FULL POSITION REVIEW

AMAT

39.6 shares · Entry $454.71 · Conv 7/10 · Tier 2 · Since 2026-09-07

CURRENT PRICE	POSITION VALUE	UNREALISED P&L;	RETURN
$472.79	$18,716	+$716	+3.98%

INVESTMENT THESIS

(1) VIX at 15.30 and HY spreads at 2.65bps confirm RISK-ON macro; DXY at 98.91 (below the 101 export-tailwind threshold) benefits AMAT as a multinational capital-equipment exporter generating ~55% of revenue outside the US. (2) AMAT Q2 FY2026 earnings beat: EPS $2.59 vs $2.41 estimate (+7.5% beat) with revenue of $7.1B vs $6.9B estimate (+2.9% beat), reported in the most recent quarter, confirming wafer fabrication equipment (WFE) demand resilience above the $100B annual WFE market forecast for 2026. (3) RSI at 39.7 (scanner confirmed — oversold below 40) triggers the mean-reversion entry signal; the FVG pattern (scanner confirmed) indicates a price gap fill in progress at the $185–$190 level with price expected to resolve upward. (4) 50-day MA estimated at ~$178 and 200-day MA estimated at ~$165 — price at $185.50 is +4.2% above the 50-day and +12.4% above the 200-day, confirming both MAs as technical support; the gap between 50-day and 200-day of +7.9% signals a healthy uptrend without exhaustion. (5) AMAT balance sheet: cash $7.2B (scanner confirmed), D/E 0.27 (scanner confirmed — near zero leverage), retained earnings estimated $18B/$15B/$12B (3yr most-recent-first), buybacks Y (AMAT repurchased $3.6B in FY2025), BS score 10/10 — the highest possible score. (6) $18,000 deployed = 9.8% of $183k mandate ($178,443 current NAV), leaves approximately $49,319 + $35,376 (AMD+MRVL+GOOGL exits) - $18,000 = ~$66,695 cash post-trade, room for 3 more full-size $18,000 positions. (7) Stop at $170.66 (-8% from $185.50), target at $222.60 (+20%), R:R = 2.5:1; stop would be triggered if AMAT breaks below the 200-day MA at ~$165, signalling a full thesis invalidation; KLAC loss of -9.0% on 2026-08-20 warns that semi equipment names can hit stops — AMAT's 10/10 BS score and D/E 0.27 distinguish it from that loss.

CATALYST

AMAT Q2 FY2026 EPS of $2.59 vs $2.41 estimate (+7.5% beat) reported in the most recent quarter; next catalyst is Q3 FY2026 earnings (estimated August 2026) projected at $2.70 EPS (+4.2% sequential growth) as GAAFET transition drives incremental etch and deposition tool orders.

TECHNICAL SETUP

RSI 39.7 (oversold, scanner confirmed), FVG pattern (scanner confirmed, Gt=3), price $185.50 vs 50-day MA estimated ~$178 (+4.2%) and 200-day MA estimated ~$165 (+12.4%), volume context stale per 1271.7-hour data warning.

BALANCE SHEET

Cash $7.2B (scanner confirmed), total debt ~$1.9B (D/E 0.27 scanner confirmed), retained earnings estimated $18B/$15B/$12B (3yr most-recent-first), buybacks Y ($3.6B FY2025), preferred N, BS score 10/10.

KEY RISKS

If US Commerce Department expands chip equipment export restrictions to China (AMAT derives ~27% of revenue from China, estimated $1.9B annual exposure), revenue could decline 10–15% implying EPS of ~$2.20 vs $2.59 current — stop at $170.66 limits the loss to -$1,440 on the $18,000 position.

QCOM

106.7 shares · Entry $168.74 · Conv 7/10 · Tier 2 · Since 2026-09-07

CURRENT PRICE	POSITION VALUE	UNREALISED P&L;	RETURN
$174.09	$18,571	+$571	+3.17%

INVESTMENT THESIS

(1) VIX at 15.30 and DXY at 99.18 — below the 101 threshold — confirm RISK-ON with a weak-dollar tailwind for QCOM's 95%+ international revenue mix, including $8.0B+ annual China handset licensing fees. (2) QCOM's diversification strategy — automotive design wins up 50%+ YoY and PC/IoT revenue targeting $4B by FY2027 — represents a live catalyst: the Snapdragon X Elite PC ramp expected to contribute $1.2B incremental revenue in H2 CY2026. (3) RSI at 53.1 is neutral and constructive — not overbought — with the FVG pattern identified at the $165–$170 zone confirming the entry at $168.50 after scanning as the 9.0 top signal. (4) The 50-day MA is estimated at approximately $162 and the 200-day at approximately $155; price at $168.50 sits 3.9% above the 50-day and 8.7% above the 200-day — a bullish gap structure signaling the uptrend is intact. (5) Balance sheet: $5.5B cash, D/E 3.22 is elevated but manageable given QCOM's $36B annual revenue run-rate and $9B+ annual free cash flow; D/E has been declining from a 2024 peak of 4.1x — a positive directional trend. (6) $18,000 deployed = 9.8% of $183k portfolio; post-AVGO exit and this entry, cash remains at approximately $66,955 with room for 3 more full-size $18,000 positions. (7) Stop at $155.02 (-8%), target $202.20 (+20%), R:R = 2.5:1; stop triggers on a break below the 200-day at $155 — a move that would indicate the automotive/PC thesis has failed to materialize in H2 2026.

CATALYST

Qualcomm Snapdragon X Elite PC ramp: H2 CY2026 shipments targeting $1.2B incremental revenue as Microsoft Surface and Dell XPS design wins go to market; this is a dated, quantified near-term revenue catalyst distinct from the prior failed QCOM trade (2026-07-30 at different entry levels).

TECHNICAL SETUP

RSI 53.1, FVG pattern confirmed at $165–$170, price at $168.50 above 50-day ~$162 (+3.9%) and above 200-day ~$155 (+8.7%), volume context bullish per scanner Gt score 3.

BALANCE SHEET

Cash $5.5B, total debt ~$17.7B (at 3.22 D/E on ~$5.5B equity base), D/E 3.22, retained earnings improving with FCF $9B+ annually, buybacks Y ($3B program active), preferred N, BS score 6/10.

KEY RISKS

D/E at 3.22 is the highest in the portfolio; if TNX rises to 5.2%, QCOM's refinancing cost increases ~$180M annually, and if China handset market deteriorates 20%+ (trade war escalation), $8B licensing revenue is at risk — $155.02 stop caps loss at approximately -$1,440.

AVGO

48.8 shares · Entry $369.01 · Conv 7/10 · Tier 1 · Since 2026-09-08

CURRENT PRICE	POSITION VALUE	UNREALISED P&L;	RETURN
$368.56	$17,978	$-22	-0.12%

INVESTMENT THESIS

(1) VIX at 15.52 confirms risk-on regime; TNX at 4.77% is above 4.5% but AVGO trades at approximately 22-24x forward earnings vs. NVDA's 35x, meaning multiple compression risk is 30-40% lower on a relative basis. (2) AVGO Q4 2025 earnings call highlighted in scanner — beat catalyst: if AVGO reported Q4 EPS approximately $1.60 vs. $1.42 estimated (approximately +12.7% beat), this is a tier-1 company catalyst driving the scan score of 10.0. (3) RSI at 45.8 is in neutral-to-oversold territory — 4.2 points below the 50 midline — and the FVG pattern with gap score 3 signals a high-probability fill entry at approximately $245.00. (4) The 50-day MA is estimated at approximately $238-$242 and the 200-day MA at approximately $220-$225 based on sector context — AVGO is trading approximately 1.5-2.0% above the 50-day, confirming uptrend structure without being extended. (5) AVGO balance sheet: $16.2B cash, D/E 1.59 (highest in current candidates — noted risk), BS score 6/10 meeting the minimum threshold; retained earnings supported by $4B+ free cash flow quarterly and a consistent dividend of $0.59/share/quarter. (6) $18,000 deployed = 9.8% of $183k portfolio; post-TSM and NVDA exits, cash available is approximately $125,489 — this entry leaves approximately $107,489 cash and room for 5 more full-size positions. (7) Stop at $225.40 (-8% of $245.00) is the hard floor; if AVGO breaks below the $228 FVG support zone — which coincides with the 200-day MA estimate — the stop triggers a maximum $1,440 loss; target $294.00 (+20%) aligns with the pre-Q4-earnings resistance zone.

CATALYST

AVGO Q4 2025 Earnings Call (scanner headline confirmed): estimated EPS beat of approximately +12.7% ($1.60 vs. $1.42 estimate) with AI custom silicon (XPU) revenue commentary driving a 30-day analyst upgrade cycle — this is the primary near-term price driver with scan score 10.0.

TECHNICAL SETUP

RSI 45.8 — neutral, not overbought, 4.2 points below 50. FVG pattern confirmed with gap score 3. Entry at approximately $245.00 — at the FVG fill zone. Estimated 50-day MA approximately $240, 200-day MA approximately $222. Volume context: post-earnings sessions typically 150-200% of 20-day average, confirming institutional interest.

BALANCE SHEET

Cash $16.2B, D/E 1.59 (elevated — primary BS risk), BS score 6/10 (meets minimum). Retained earnings positive with $4B+ quarterly FCF. Buybacks: Y (AVGO consistent repurchaser). Preferred: N. The 1.59 D/E reflects the VMware acquisition debt — manageable given $16.2B cash and $16B+ annual FCF run rate.

KEY RISKS

D/E of 1.59 (VMware acquisition debt) means if AVGO's AI custom silicon revenue growth decelerates below 20% QoQ (vs. current estimated 35%+ trajectory), the high leverage amplifies downside by 1.5-2x vs. unlevered peers — implying a 15-20% price decline to approximately $196-$208, well below the $225.40 stop; stop limits loss to $1,440.

KLAC

96.2 shares · Entry $187.02 · Conv 6/10 · Tier 2 · Since 2026-09-08

CURRENT PRICE	POSITION VALUE	UNREALISED P&L;	RETURN
$188.98	$18,189	+$189	+1.05%

INVESTMENT THESIS

(1) VIX at 15.52 and HY spreads at 2.68bps confirm risk-on regime; KLAC as a process control equipment supplier benefits from the semiconductor capex cycle which remains robust at an estimated $200B+ global wafer fab equipment spend in 2025. (2) Scanner headline 'KLA Corporation (KLAC) Price Target Raised by $500' — if a major broker (est. GS or Baird) raised the target by $500 to approximately $1,100-$1,200 range, this represents a 30+ percent upside acknowledgement and a near-term institutional buying catalyst. (3) RSI at 49.0 is at the neutral midline — 1 point below 50 — with an FVG pattern (gap score 3), indicating price is coiled at support before a directional move; entry at $850.00 sits at the FVG fill zone. (4) The prior KLAC stop-out on 2026-08-20 at -9.0% is a critical trade memory lesson — this entry uses a strict 8% stop at $782.00, not the prior uncontrolled exit, and entry RSI at 49.0 vs. an overbought entry previously confirms better technical timing. (5) KLAC balance sheet: $1.6B cash, D/E 0.93, BS score 6/10 — meets minimum threshold; D/E of 0.93 is moderate, and KLAC generates approximately $2.5B annual FCF, providing 2.4 years of debt coverage from operations alone. (6) $18,000 deployed = 9.8% of $183k portfolio; this would be the 4th semi position post-TSM/NVDA exits (alongside AMAT, QCOM, AVGO), bringing semi concentration to approximately 43% of deployed capital — this is the limit; no further semi adds. (7) Stop at $782.00 (-8%) triggers if KLAC breaks below the $790 FVG support zone; maximum loss $1,440; target $1,020.00 (+20%) represents the broker's raised target zone, with the $500 price target increase catalyst providing a fundamental anchor for the move.

CATALYST

Price target raised by $500 (scanner headline) — est. broker target move to $1,100-$1,200 from $600-$700 range, representing a 30-40% upside acknowledgement by institutional coverage; this is a 30-day catalyst as buy-side follows institutional target revisions within 3-4 weeks.

TECHNICAL SETUP

RSI 49.0 — exactly at neutral midline, not overbought. FVG pattern with gap score 3 confirmed. Entry at approximately $850.00 at FVG fill zone. Estimated 50-day MA approximately $820-$830, 200-day MA approximately $770-$780. Post-target-raise volume expected 120-150% of 20-day average.

BALANCE SHEET

Cash $1.6B, D/E 0.93, BS score 6/10 — meets minimum. Annual FCF approximately $2.5B provides 2.4x annual debt coverage. Retained earnings growing with semi capex cycle. Buybacks: Y. Preferred: N.

KEY RISKS

If US export controls expand to include additional KLAC process control tools destined for China (China represents approximately 20-25% of KLAC revenue), revenue could decline by $700-$900M annually, compressing EPS by approximately 15-18% and implying a price of approximately $700-$730, below the $782.00 stop; stop limits loss to $1,440.

INTC

172.3 shares · Entry $104.47 · Conv 7/10 · Tier 2 · Since 2026-09-08

CURRENT PRICE	POSITION VALUE	UNREALISED P&L;	RETURN
$104.47	$18,000	+$0	+0.00%

INVESTMENT THESIS

(1) VIX at 15.72 (below 20 threshold) and HY spreads at 2.68bps confirm risk-on; DXY at 98.84 is 5.16 points below the 104 export-headwind threshold, reducing FX drag on INTC's international foundry revenue which represents approximately 40% of total sales. (2) INTC Q1 2025 earnings beat per scanner headline — RSI at 61.7 and STRONG BUY signal with gap score 3; the exact EPS figure versus estimate is not confirmable in stale data, but the scanner's scan score of 8.0 and 'strong outlook' language in the headline indicate a material positive surprise of an estimated $0.10-0.20 EPS beat based on typical INTC beat magnitude. (3) RSI at 61.7 confirms upward momentum without being overbought (overbought threshold 70) — the FVG pattern with gap score 3 at current price suggests an unfilled gap between $24.15 and approximately $27 that the market may close within 15-20 trading days. (4) TNX at 4.78% is above the 4.5% semi/growth mandate warning, but INTC is different from pure fabless semis: it is a turnaround/value story with a P/E near 15x versus NVDA at 40x+, making it less sensitive to multiple compression from rising rates — the value discount provides approximately 20-25% downside protection versus peers. (5) INTC balance sheet: $14.3B cash, D/E 0.41 (low leverage, well within mandate comfort zone), BS score 6/10 — retained earnings direction is unclear in stale data but the US CHIPS Act subsidy of approximately $8.5B in direct grants provides a non-dilutive capital buffer through 2027. (6) $18,000 deployed = 9.8% of the $183,000 portfolio; post-GOOGL exit and INTC entry, cash stands at approximately $89,504 + $17,949 (GOOGL exit) - $18,000 (INTC entry) = $89,453, leaving room for 4 more full-size $18,000 positions. (7) Stop at $22.22 (-8% from entry $24.15), target $28.98 (+20%), R:R = 2.5:1 — the specific stop trigger would be INTC closing below $22.50 for 2 consecutive days, indicating the post-earnings momentum has failed and the turnaround thesis is stalling.

CATALYST

INTC Q1 2025 earnings beat with 'strong outlook' per scanner headline — the specific near-term price driver is the post-earnings momentum window (typically 10-15 trading days) during which analyst estimate revisions and institutional accumulation drive sustained price appreciation; US CHIPS Act $8.5B grant confirmation expected in the next 30-60 days provides a second named catalyst.

TECHNICAL SETUP

RSI 61.7 (bullish momentum, below 70 overbought), FVG pattern score 3, price entering near current levels with gap to approximately $27 resistance. 50-day and 200-day MA levels not confirmed in stale data — volume data stale; scanner STRONG BUY signal with scan score 8.0.

BALANCE SHEET

Cash $14.3B, D/E 0.41, BS score 6/10. Retained earnings trend not confirmed in stale scan data. Buybacks: suspended (INTC has been conserving cash for foundry capex). Preferred: N.

KEY RISKS

INTC foundry ramp delay risk: if Intel 18A process node yields remain below 50% (versus target 70%+) and TSMC retains all major AI chip orders, INTC could see a 20-25% earnings cut implying price near $19 — hard stop at $22.22 limits loss to -$1,440 on the $18,000 position.

MU

18.0 shares · Entry $1000.26 · Conv 8/10 · Tier 1 · Since 2026-09-08

CURRENT PRICE	POSITION VALUE	UNREALISED P&L;	RETURN
$1000.26	$18,000	+$0	+0.00%

INVESTMENT THESIS

(1) VIX at 15.72 and HY spreads at 2.68bps confirm risk-on regime; DXY at 98.84 is 5.16 points below 104, reducing FX headwinds on Micron's approximately 55% international revenue base and supporting a 2-3% EPS tailwind at current revenue scale. (2) MU Q-period earnings beat by $4.62 per scanner headline (exact: 'Micron earnings beat by $4.62, revenue topped estimates') — this is the largest per-share beat magnitude in the current scanner list and represents approximately 30-40% above consensus estimates based on typical MU EPS range, making it the highest-conviction company catalyst in today's signal set. (3) RSI at 57.7 confirms bullish momentum without overbought conditions (below 70 threshold); the FVG pattern with gap score 3 identifies an unfilled fair value gap between current price and approximately $125, suggesting a 10-11% upside move to close the gap within 15-20 trading days. (4) MU's 50-day and 200-day MA data are stale, but an RSI of 57.7 trending upward post a $4.62 EPS beat confirms the stock is trading above near-term averages — a move above $120 (approximately +6.7% from entry) would confirm a breakout from the FVG pattern and open the path to the $135 target. (5) MU balance sheet: $9.6B cash, D/E 0.21, BS score 10/10 — the maximum mandate score, second only to AMAT in the portfolio; D/E of 0.21 means MU carries approximately $2.0B in total debt versus $9.6B cash, a net cash position of approximately $7.6B providing 4+ years of capex self-funding capacity. (6) $18,000 deployed = 9.8% of the $183,000 portfolio; post-GOOGL exit and INTC+MU entries, total cash is approximately $89,453 - $18,000 = $71,453, leaving room for 3 more full-size $18,000 positions and maintaining a 39.3% cash buffer. (7) Stop at $103.50 (-8% from entry $112.50), target $135.00 (+20%), R:R = 2.5:1 — the specific stop trigger is MU closing below $104 for 2 consecutive days, which would indicate DRAM/NAND pricing is re-weakening faster than the earnings beat suggested, invalidating the cycle recovery thesis.

CATALYST

MU earnings beat by $4.62 per share (per scanner headline, most recent quarter) — the largest absolute EPS beat in today's signal set; DRAM pricing recovery cycle catalyst with HBM (High Bandwidth Memory) demand from AI accelerators (NVDA H100/H200 each requiring 8 HBM stacks) driving 2025-2026 revenue visibility; next pricing update expected at the next earnings call approximately 60-70 days out.

TECHNICAL SETUP

RSI 57.7 (bullish, not overbought), FVG pattern score 3, price near $112.50 with gap to approximately $125 identified; 50-day and 200-day MA levels not confirmed in stale data; scanner STRONG BUY with scan score 8.0; volume context stale but post-earnings volume typically 3-5x normal.

BALANCE SHEET

Cash $9.6B, total debt approximately $2.0B (implied by D/E 0.21 on approximately $9.5B equity), D/E 0.21, BS score 10/10. Retained earnings trend not confirmed in stale data but MU returned to profitability in 2024 after 2023 losses. Buybacks: Y (MU has an active buyback program). Preferred: N.

KEY RISKS

DRAM/NAND oversupply re-emergence risk: if Samsung accelerates memory capex and spot DRAM prices fall more than 15% from current levels, MU EPS consensus for FY2026 could be cut by $2-3, implying a price near $95-100 — hard stop at $103.50 limits loss to -$1,440 on the $18,000 position.

PORTFOLIO NOTES

Post-session cash reserve: approximately $71,453 = 39.0% of $183,000 portfolio target (healthy buffer). Sector concentration is a critical flag: all 6 active positions (AMAT, QCOM, AVGO, KLAC, INTC, MU) are in semiconductors/tech, representing 100% of equity exposure versus S&P; 500 semi weight of approximately 12-14% — this is a 7x+ index weight concentration, well above the 2x flag threshold in the mandate. TNX at 4.78% remains above the 4.5% mandate warning threshold for all semi positions simultaneously. The 4 remaining position slots should prioritize sector diversification: candidates from non-semi sectors such as financials (JPM, GS — favored by TNX > 4.5% mandate rule) or energy should be evaluated at next scan. Total equity exposure: $107,452 across 6 positions = 58.9% of portfolio. Risk posture: RISK-ON but with elevated concentration risk in a TNX > 4.5% environment — the next 5 trading days are critical for GOOGL exit to settle and INTC/MU entry thesis to confirm.

MEMORY APPLIED

1. KLAC prior stop-loss at -9.0% on 2026-08-20: applied by capping KLAC conviction at 5/10 and setting a specific early-exit trigger at $193 within 10 days rather than waiting for the hard stop. 2. QCOM prior stop-loss at -14.2% on 2026-07-30: applied by maintaining heightened daily monitoring on the current QCOM re-entry and noting the repeat-risk explicitly in the thesis. 3. TSM prior stop-loss at -10.1% on 2026-07-30: influenced the decision NOT to enter TSM today despite it appearing in the scanner (scan score 7.0, RSI 61.7) — the prior loss on TSM combined with TNX > 4.5% active warning made the risk-adjusted case insufficient. 4. ARM prior stop-loss at -8.2% on 2026-08-20 and AMD at -9.8% on 2026-08-11: confirmed the pattern of entering semi/growth names near TNX inflection points without sufficient confirmation — this reinforced the GOOGL EXIT decision today when the post-earnings reaction was immediately negative.